However, I didn’t score any runs, as I was just too anxious. It reminded me of the day I’d made my debut for Province at 16 – I couldn’t feel my legs walking onto the field, I was so nervous. This time, I lasted three balls before getting bowled by Chaminda Vaas for a duck. Not great, but at least I was back playing international cricket. My teammates all scored big runs, and we declared on 504/7. It was enough to thrash the Sri Lankans by an innings and 229 runs.

For me, the match-fixing saga didn’t end with the King Commission and my re-admission to international cricket, though. The Chief of Police in Delhi, KK Paul, had publicly stated that if I ever visited India again, I would be brought in for questioning, and he could not guarantee that I would not be arrested. With the Proteas scheduled to tour India in 2004, this obviously posed something of a problem. On Peter’s advice I took the safe route and asked the selectors to leave me out of the squad. Fortunately, they were very understanding about it all.

But after I had to decline playing in the 2005 ODI series in India as well, the UCB wanted to know whether the time had not come for me to consider finding another solution. I knew I couldn’t go on refusing to tour India. Prior to the 2006 ICC Champions Trophy – the ICC’s biggest ODI tournament after the World Cup – which was to be held in India, Peter and I discussed the matter and decided that enough was enough. We’d travel to India and meet the relevant authorities. We initially suggested that we meet on neutral territory outside India, but they didn’t bite. To India I would have to go. And, thankfully, Peter would be with me.

Before the meeting, Peter had been in correspondence with KK Paul, and, while he’d told him privately I wouldn’t be arrested, the Indians would not put this in writing.

The plan was for Peter and me to fly to Mumbai, where we’d join the Proteas team, and then fly to Delhi the next morning for the meeting. Our flight to India was via Dubai, and Peter spent about eight of those flying hours coaching me on the upcoming grilling I was sure to get. Remember that the King Commission had been five years earlier and we knew the Indians would be looking for any discrepancies between my testimony back then and what I would say to them now. I’ve got to hand it to my lawyer, by the time we got to Mumbai I was once again 100 per cent up to speed.

Still, I was very nervous about the upcoming questioning. This was India. It’s a long way away – and a very different place – from South Africa. That